

max- x j-eremy - 2026/06/01 15:29 BST - Transcript

Attendees

Jeremy Mcdonald, Max Woelfle

Transcript

Jeremy Mcdonald: draft me an email to Katie, the CEO of 12 NYC, a merchandise company that my friends work for, and she reached out "Hi, Katie." Aiden, I believe Aiden reached out to see and, get in touch. I'm actually in New York this week. attending a hackathon. so I'm around on Friday if you'd love to have a coffee or we can jump on the call, whatever's easier for keen to chat to you about AI because I understand your guys position. Hello mate.

Max Woelfle: Hey Jeremy, what's up?

Jeremy Mcdonald: I was just transcribing an email so it's good cut off.

Max Woelfle: Nice. How's life?

Jeremy Mcdonald: Yeah, it's good.

Jeremy Mcdonald: Back from Albania. Knackered, but fine. Champions League final. Arsenal lost, didn't they? It was close though.

Max Woelfle: True. You're an Arsenal fan, right? Yeah.

Jeremy Mcdonald: Yeah, I got season ticket. It's fine. We won the league. I'm not that bothered.

Max Woelfle: And honestly, I mean the penalties that's just pure luck and then in the end...

Jeremy Mcdonald: Yeah. Yeah.

Max Woelfle: who cares like it's a Mhm.

Jeremy Mcdonald: But yeah, all good. But yeah, so the profounder doing this marketing engineering thing looks interesting. I applied for it. We're really good fit, but then I'm like, " f***.

Jeremy Mcdonald: I don't actually use profound that much."

Jeremy Mcdonald: And whenever I speak to you, normally I come away inspired. So I thought I'd pick your beautiful brain to try and think of something good.

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Max Woelfle: All right,...

Max Woelfle: that sounds amazing. I mean, I can give you a few insights. I mean, I talked to Profound when I was in London a few days after we went to this amazing standup comedy thing. which by the way,...

Max Woelfle: again, I'm still happy that I could tag along for that. That was cool.

Jeremy Mcdonald: Okay, don't worry about Yeah.

Max Woelfle: And I talked to profound there and one thing that they were really proud of is their whole agent setup, So in the tool you have agents that then can turn the insights into actions. I would say in terms of building something it should always be insights to actions kind of right That's Mhm.

Jeremy Mcdonald: And sorry I just jump in. I can wait till the end. But the insights they have right because there is a lot of your tool you built about what models think about you without using the internet. Really interesting. I don't have access to profound anymore. So what actual insights do they have?

Jeremy Mcdonald: They have the typed queries about what do they actually have?

Max Woelfle: So I don't have access to profound either at the moment...

Max Woelfle: but I kind of recall from the conversations we had with them. So in general what they do is they scrape prompts...

Jeremy Mcdonald: Yep.

Max Woelfle: which I mean everybody does and I think what I actually like a lot is data for SEO and...

Jeremy Mcdonald: Yeah. Then okay.

Max Woelfle: you can just pull stuff from there it's essentially very similar. so they scrape the prompts similar what peak does. then what they ingest is the product feed that you send to Google Merchant Center which I think on a product layer is actually really interesting right because that is your direct connection to the AI and it's very similar to the Google Merchant Center feed is probably what Google is going

Max Woelfle: to use more likely than anything else than any MCP, all of that talk, like all the UCP protocol, all that b****. Google already has the Google Merchant Center feed. And we had two workshops with the people that build the Google Merchant Center and...

Max Woelfle: built a conversational layer around that. and they said why should we use anything else than the Merchant Center feed that has everything? We just want to enrich that feed. And I think that's probably where I would see a lot of the development in the near future going is really around the feeds, right? and...

Jeremy Mcdonald: So the agent thing they have essentially is they have native agents...

Max Woelfle: because you have the ACP feed. and I can look who gives a s***. I can show you some of the insights here already. Let me find the right Yeah.

Jeremy Mcdonald: which are either going to be managed agents or basically they're going to be a third party wrapper of a AI interface that runs as an agent.

Max Woelfle: Yeah. Yeah. that's also what they showed me. So they had one of their engineers there and I don't know if you've seen it but I participated in this PKI hackathon...

Jeremy Mcdonald: Okay. No.

Max Woelfle: which was ultimately very similar. There's a LinkedIn post that I didn't win so f*** KI. but hold on. Can I find that? and essentially what I built with the peak MCP was you would look at your list of prompts. you would then look at which products like I did it for cooking pots,...

Jeremy Mcdonald: Yeah, there

Max Woelfle: For WF is a German cooking pot manufacturer a bit like Lucette. I don't know if that So I just looked at where do they don't show up and then basically you look at the sources where're You look at your product feed and you pick the product that is most that is best suited to be featured in that article or listical or whatever.

Max Woelfle: you look up who the author of the content piece is or you can use Clay to even enrich that data to find out who the person is that you would like the editor or whoever and then you send them and...

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Max Woelfle: then Claude would draft an email that would say hey we notice that you write about cooking pots we believe that this cooking pot is a great fit for this article here's a link to our affiliate program please consider mentioning so basically automating the whole PR outreach on a product specific basis. That's the workflow that I built.

Jeremy Mcdonald: Who ons.

Max Woelfle: That's a good question. the thing is the people who won had much easier solutions that peak could sell better.

Jeremy Mcdonald: Okay. Yeah.

Max Woelfle: So this is why I would say for example and this is what I didn't think of. I just built something that I thought was cool.

Jeremy Mcdonald: Yeah, that's what I did. I did an open AI one and I fell down the same track.

Max Woelfle: But they actually want something that...

Jeremy Mcdonald: Yeah, just

Max Woelfle: if they're selling dashboards build a dashboard a bit like that's bit the idea, right? so I can think of let me just I mean you'll find it somewhere in the peak posts that's the link I'll send it to you on WhatsApp that's maybe I know not on how should I send it to you because on WhatsApp it's gone after yeah so

Jeremy Mcdonald: send on here and I'll open it and then it'll be in my history go operating system.

Max Woelfle: That's the link. So, that's who won the MCP challenge there. And, I think P MC Yeah. And Yeah.

Jeremy Mcdonald: Lily Ray big dogs mate. no, she was a judge.

Max Woelfle:

Max Woelfle: She was a judge.

Jeremy Mcdonald: Yeah, I just got picked for Brighton SEO in October doing a little talk there, but I'll probably be on some sort of lowgrade stage. Okay. Yeah,...

Max Woelfle: You pitch for Brighton in October.

Jeremy Mcdonald: I've got an agent that pitches for everything for me. So, it finds them all for me and I then pitch later.

Jeremy Mcdonald: But yeah, I did the main stage a couple of years ago last year and...

Max Woelfle: Nice.

Jeremy Mcdonald: then this will be some sort of niche back room...

Jeremy Mcdonald: because they sell so much sponsored now 60% of it are paid for. I think that's a bit s***.

Max Woelfle: Really?

Max Woelfle: Yeah.

Jeremy Mcdonald: I think personally Mine looks like this.

Max Woelfle: I completely miss out on that. Can you share that Asian with me because I need to pitch talks a bit more in a let's say organized way because I think there's so much I can talk about but I just don't have the bandwidth or the focus to always follow. H

Jeremy Mcdonald: So, I built it into a thing So, I have email agent that's integrated and drafts my Gmails. I have a sales agent that does all my prospecting. I have a speaker agent that looks at speaker stuff. I have a client status sheet. I have one that does my task. But I'll package up.

Jeremy Mcdonald: I'll get Claude to package up that and send it to you because it does find speaking opportunities. It updates a sheet for me and then I look at that on a weekly basis. I get it to run in the background and then go, " can you do that?" And then let me find It updates this sheets of events and...

Jeremy Mcdonald: then I track the ones I pitch for. And so it's still manual. It's still human in loop, but I just use it for that prospecting stuff.

Max Woelfle: Yeah. No,...

Max Woelfle: that's really cool because I mean I did a Brighton talk during the pandemic that was it but not the same experience but yeah back to the MCP topic so that was the challenge from peak when talking to profound basically what really sets them apart at the moment is that they have these integrated agents So really more like a and...

Max Woelfle: how they kind of try to pitch it to me was look it's a bit like an N8N flow and...

Jeremy Mcdonald: Yeah. they're already doing content recommendations and...

Max Woelfle: you can build all of that in here and it's again from insights to actions and from the insights You have those scraped results and as another insight you have your product feeds and then you can say for example how accurate is the data about your products on AI.

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Jeremy Mcdonald: stuff? they not doing that yet?

Max Woelfle: Yeah, they're doing content recommendations. that was the first thing that they tried to pitch.

Jeremy Mcdonald: Yeah. Yeah.

Max Woelfle: back in remember when we met in November in London.

Jeremy Mcdonald: Yeah. I'm skeptical of it. we're both like, " I don't really want it doing that."

Jeremy Mcdonald: And I still sort of agree with that,...

Max Woelfle: Yeah. ...

Jeremy Mcdonald: but It helps. Yeah.

Max Woelfle: what I do think is having generally content ideas based on the existing content that you have or maybe even having an agent that knows what content does your organization know that is not out there yet? I think maybe something a bit like and then creating a brief something where you say, "Hey, this information is actually really missing online." You might have the internal knowledge to fill that gap. Create something around that. Here are some pointers on where to start and...

Max Woelfle: maybe the content brief is created. But again what I think is complete b*** is like an completely automated content production line.

Jeremy Mcdonald: Yeah. ...

Jeremy Mcdonald: that's and the problem is they'll lean into that. And then this one's all about Use AI and scale that isn't humanly possible. Content optimization is too small for me. The feed stuff's interesting, but you'll be like, how could you inform your next product or how could you use but once more I don't think it's revolutionary enough. the thing that we spoke about on page copy and...

Jeremy Mcdonald: turning historic information about product planning into fe that's interesting, but it'd be hard to use their agents. So yeah, I don't know.

Jeremy Mcdonald: I think normally I'm inspired by this stuff, but it's quite hard because do they actually scrape it or are they just inputting it via the API like everyone else? And how do they scrape it?

Max Woelfle: I do think that they scrape it.

Max Woelfle: I think they run it in with a headless browser.

Jeremy Mcdonald: Okay, but they're still just inputting prompts, right? They haven't got out of that loop of prompt input.

Max Woelfle: No, my understanding there's no conversation. It's a prompt result monitoring and you can actually see it sometimes and this would maybe be one of the things I see this more and...

Max Woelfle: more in the prompt monitoring is that the result is actually a question versus a response and one could I mean this is a small thing more like a product feature that you would flag the prompts that cause a question rather than a result and...

Jeremy Mcdonald: Thank you.

Max Woelfle: then create a new prompt that answers that question towards something and...

Jeremy Mcdonald: Yeah. Yeah.

Max Woelfle: then you have a new prompt and you kind of bundle them. I don't know that's Yeah.

Jeremy Mcdonald: Yeah. you're their target customer, right?

Jeremy Mcdonald: What would be a genuine problem for scale that currently exists for you that is unsolvable with...

Jeremy Mcdonald: what you're doing currently that you'll be like if I can go I can do that you're super excited. Is it the product descriptions, integrated intelligence from that? what is there anything that stands out to you around that? Yeah.

Max Woelfle: Look, I mean I would say that the biggest problem that I have and...

Max Woelfle: that's not solved is that I need to provide a KPI I to the management of the company that gives an idea of how we're doing on AI search, how are we doing well or bad? who knows, right? That's and that metric and at the moment visibility for most people visibility is that metric but that metric is really not perfect right...

Max Woelfle:

Jeremy Mcdonald: Yeah. ...

Max Woelfle: because it depends so much on what you actually monitor and the next problem with that metric is when we introduced the ACP feeds traffic from open AAI went up We had three times the sessions. The visibility didn't change at all.

Jeremy Mcdonald: you said in your talk

Max Woelfle: And that's really the problem with visibility is it doesn't really connect to business goals. It doesn't connect to sessions. It doesn't really connect to maybe because we didn't set it up correctly. It just doesn't connect to revenue either. So that's really the problem with visibility as a score is that you have the metric here but the business reality is actually somewhere else. So that's the biggest problem is to ...

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Max Woelfle: how can I have a metric that I can use as a north star that I can optimize towards that I can tie to company goals and business targets. and that is actually reliable. And to be honest, I don't think that that's solved at the moment.

Jeremy Mcdonald: it's not going to be like first say profound valuation is ridiculous...

Jeremy Mcdonald: because it's an input output machine right what you

Jeremy Mcdonald: put in. but secondly, it's not going to be resolved until there's a search console for it and then you'll have impressions and then it'll be impressions and...

Jeremy Mcdonald: then you'll have visibility and impressions and you have a me weighted metrics and ultimately for you to be able to discover what drove that three-fold increase is impossible in the current ecosystem unless you had a million prompts and even then all that would happen is you would still have the visibility score. It may be like a small percent. Yep.

Max Woelfle: exactly. ...

Max Woelfle: So, let's say that's the biggest problem, And I don't think there's really a good solution for that now. And I think that would be the \$1 million fix. another challenge I would say is how can you visualize let's say visibility is the best that we have for the time being. How can we actually work out the differences in a reporting or...

Jeremy Mcdonald: Yeah.

Max Woelfle: an automized way between countries because I can monitor prompts for the UK, for the US and for Australia and I can have my visibility scores for each. And again I think this is something more likely to win. having a dashboard or having an agent that highlights the differences between countries. So you can say look we're happy and this is actually where you can bring in let's say my US team but let's ignore the US because it's too big. Let's take Australia. And I know that my ecom numbers for the UK are good. For Canada and Australia they're not as an example, right?

Max Woelfle: And then I can tie that to how is my performance on AI for each respective country and...

Max Woelfle: why am I doing better in the UK if I'm doing better than in Australia and in Canada and then really say okay look maybe in the UK these sources matter more or the official source like the NHS pick up the brand whereas the health ministry in Australia doesn't and...

Jeremy Mcdonald: Yeah. that struck an idea for me...

Max Woelfle: that type of and having a dashboard or a

Jeremy Mcdonald: which is that but a bit further. So the thing we're building for LEGO is centralized dashboard that enables their team to I'm coping with Robert my contact but that has centralized dashboard so when you log on it it answers based off your job title and role what your questions will be.

Jeremy Mcdonald: So it knows yours predominantly going to be what visibility has changed what is the difference in between Australia is there any content we need to localize into model language a product

person it's going to be what are the most frequent prompts people use about cloud monster for a finance person it's going to be like we could apply that theory to that that answers your question as well as other questions and...

Jeremy Mcdonald: then pre sets up like a dashboard that is a chat interface but

Jeremy Mcdonald: preloaded FAQs of...

Max Woelfle: Mhm. Yeah.

Jeremy Mcdonald: what it looks like and that to me if done correctly enables it to dive down your area which is a really good idea but also because the key thing for them is what could not be done what is there no way to have the scale of previously and what can AI facilitate and that to me fits with your answer and a lot more that to them is quite viable. Yeah. Yeah.

Max Woelfle:

Max Woelfle: Yeah. Yeah. Because I think at the moment everything is very much focused on one market but actually the challenge that companies have is okay and how do I scale this on a global level especially because profound they have global clients right so I think that that could be one interesting thing and then also I mean the question is depending on some verticals let's

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Max Woelfle: you have the same queries or prompts worldwide because an operating system is operating system in Brazil and in Japan and in Germany for running it's a bit different for any sports activities it's a bit different...

Jeremy Mcdonald: Mhm. Thank you.

Max Woelfle: because in India you're going to run indoors in Dubai whereas you in Switzerland you go trail running because it's beautiful and the world is not polluted to the extent that it's somewhere else. So that's a challenge that we have is it doesn't really make sense to monitor the same prompts and...

Jeremy Mcdonald: Yeah. Yeah.

Max Woelfle: just translate them to a different country which again very specific niche problem for something like that a bit too early. Yeah.

Jeremy Mcdonald: Yeah. But there's something nice there's market level insight. There may be one or two third party sources I can pull into it like Reddit sentiment, drag that into it. Then you look at personalization and scaling it based on the person interacting with it. So a finance director can log into ask questions, a product an Indian market person can log onto it. I feel that that's nice. It answers some of the stuff you're saying. It's not impossible to build because they already have the ecosystem for it and it genuinely just uses their product. that's all they give f*** about. They're like, "How can we promote profound?" Yeah.

Max Woelfle: Yeah, I have another very different business problem that one could look at and...

Jeremy Mcdonald: Yeah. Go.

Max Woelfle: that's not so much the case on but for probably many other companies. So you have traditional search traffic is going down and...

Jeremy Mcdonald: Yeah. Yeah.

Max Woelfle: you would want if I'm the CMO of a company, I see traditional search is going down and AI search is the pure session numbers is not picking it up. But what I could try to visualize or I could try to maybe say okay because now my challenge is what do we do and...

Jeremy Mcdonald: Yep. Yeah.

Max Woelfle: how do we fill that gap and one could try to give more context about just basically answering the questions where have the organic searches gone and if you say they have gone and for example you could pull from search console these are your biggest losers. So let's say you have some content pieces and you can say okay actually you're losing content here or...

Max Woelfle: You used to get a lot of clicks for let's say how to prepare a marathon.

Jeremy Mcdonald: Yeah. Yeah.

Max Woelfle: Those are the clicks you're using. Let's look at is there an AI overview because I do think profound scrapes those as well. Is there an AI overview? Are you cited? Yes or no? And is this...

Jeremy Mcdonald: Yeah. Yeah.

Max Woelfle: how likely is this type of traffic to be more informational? So if it's more informational, what actually matters is that because you never had a conversion from that article You just want the exposure. So now let's take the content of this article,...

Jeremy Mcdonald: Yeah. Yeah. Yeah.

Max Woelfle: have something similar as a prompt and are we showing up as a citation for AI results. And if we do green check mark, maybe our impression has just moved somewhere else. We cannot measure it, but has moved somewhere else. Or you have a big blinking red X and say look, you're not only losing the sessions, you're also losing the touch point with a consumer.

Max Woelfle: Do something maybe honestly that's a bit simpler. I think that could be something useful.

Jeremy Mcdonald: Yeah. Yeah.

Jeremy Mcdonald: I love That's great, too. And also that ties to them trying to sell more with their sort of platform.

Max Woelfle: Yeah. Yeah.

Jeremy Mcdonald: All Very valuable as always, mate. I appreciate it.* been doing you a favor, hasn't he?

Max Woelfle: Yeah. He has I can I was actually looking into the search let me share that with you...

Max Woelfle: because I have it open right now. I'm really happy to hear that.

Jeremy Mcdonald: I've already got his top,...

Jeremy Mcdonald: I wear it all the time. I've got his horrible sort lovely pink and black. I wear that.

Max Woelfle: That's what it's supposed to be.

Jeremy Mcdonald: Yeah. Yeah.

Max Woelfle: This is our BigQuery dashboard for search. So, basically, it filters to the pages that have jaw in the URL.

Jeremy Mcdonald: Yeah, that Brazil is insane.

Max Woelfle: And you can see how the clicks to Yeah,...

Jeremy Mcdonald: 2.9 2.1 mil impressions.

Max Woelfle: that's the impressions and you can see how it just skyrockets here. It's and...

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Jeremy Mcdonald: Jovovic, you beat Jock and then he did Rude last night, too, which I wasn't loving because I had a bet on Rude.

Max Woelfle: don't ever bet on sports if any bet on Yeah.

Jeremy Mcdonald: It's jovial.

Jeremy Mcdonald: I don't care. It's like a pint. But Yeah.

Max Woelfle: I have a friend of mine, he always bets he's a Bremen supporter just like me.

Jeremy Mcdonald: Yeah. Yeah.

Max Woelfle: We were born in the same city. and he always bets against Bremen. So when they lose, he gets some money.

Jeremy Mcdonald: Yeah. Yeah.

Max Woelfle: When they win, he's just happy. He doesn't care about the money So yeah.

Jeremy Mcdonald: That's not a bad point. All right. I'll let you go, mate. You're very helpful as always. thank you.

Max Woelfle: I'm keeping me posted from New York. All right. Good luck there. Take care.

Jeremy Mcdonald: Catch up soon. Bye-bye.

Meeting ended after 00:31:00 🙌

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